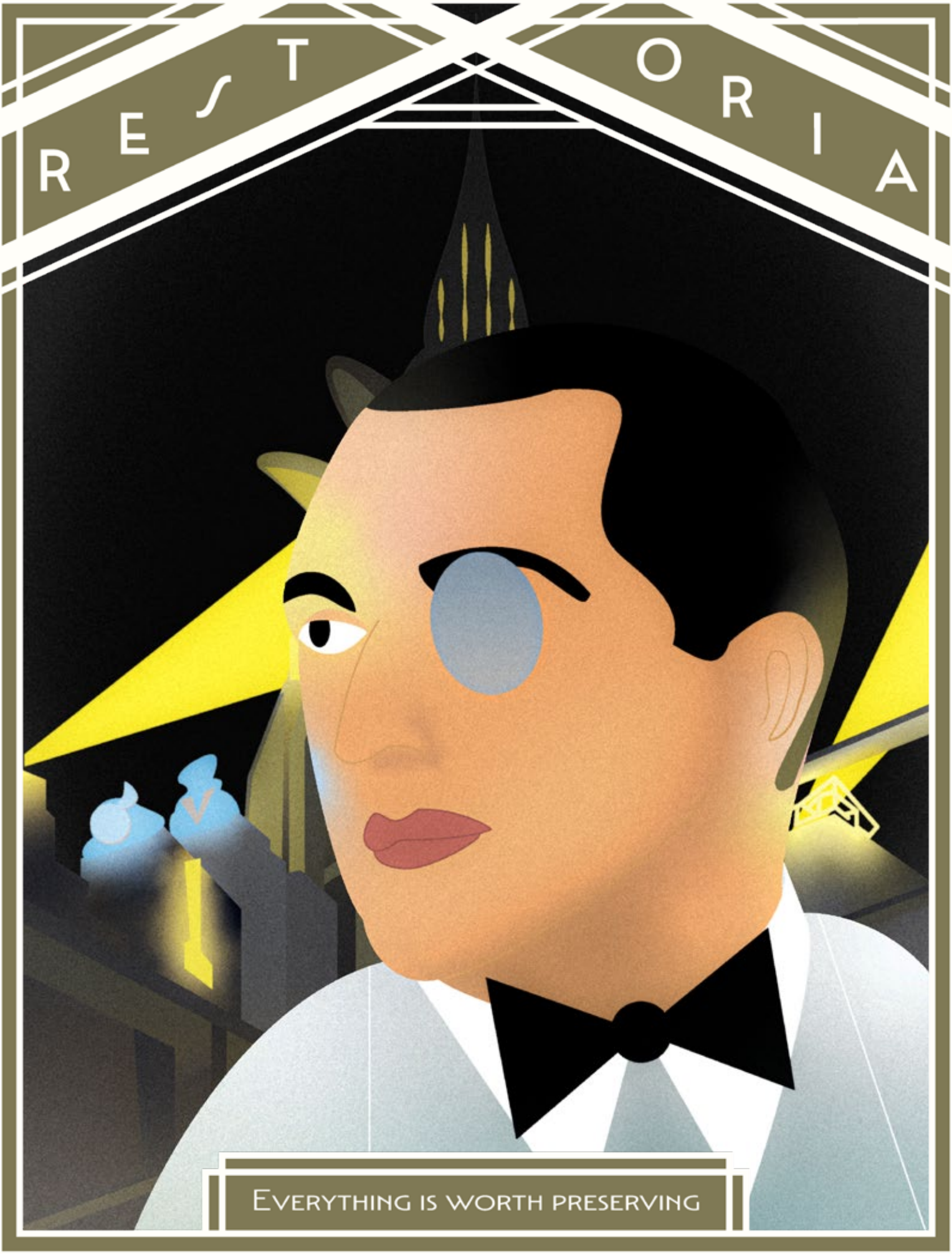

RESTORIA
EVERYTHING IS WORTH PRESERVING

MAP OF RESTORIA

LEGENDA
- Railways
- Big City
- River

Tatooine

Gotham City

Metropolis

LAKE KAMBEI

Criterion City

District 12

Gallifrey

Middle-Earth

BFI

The Grand-Father of Film Noir

We interviewed Fritz Lang about his film career.

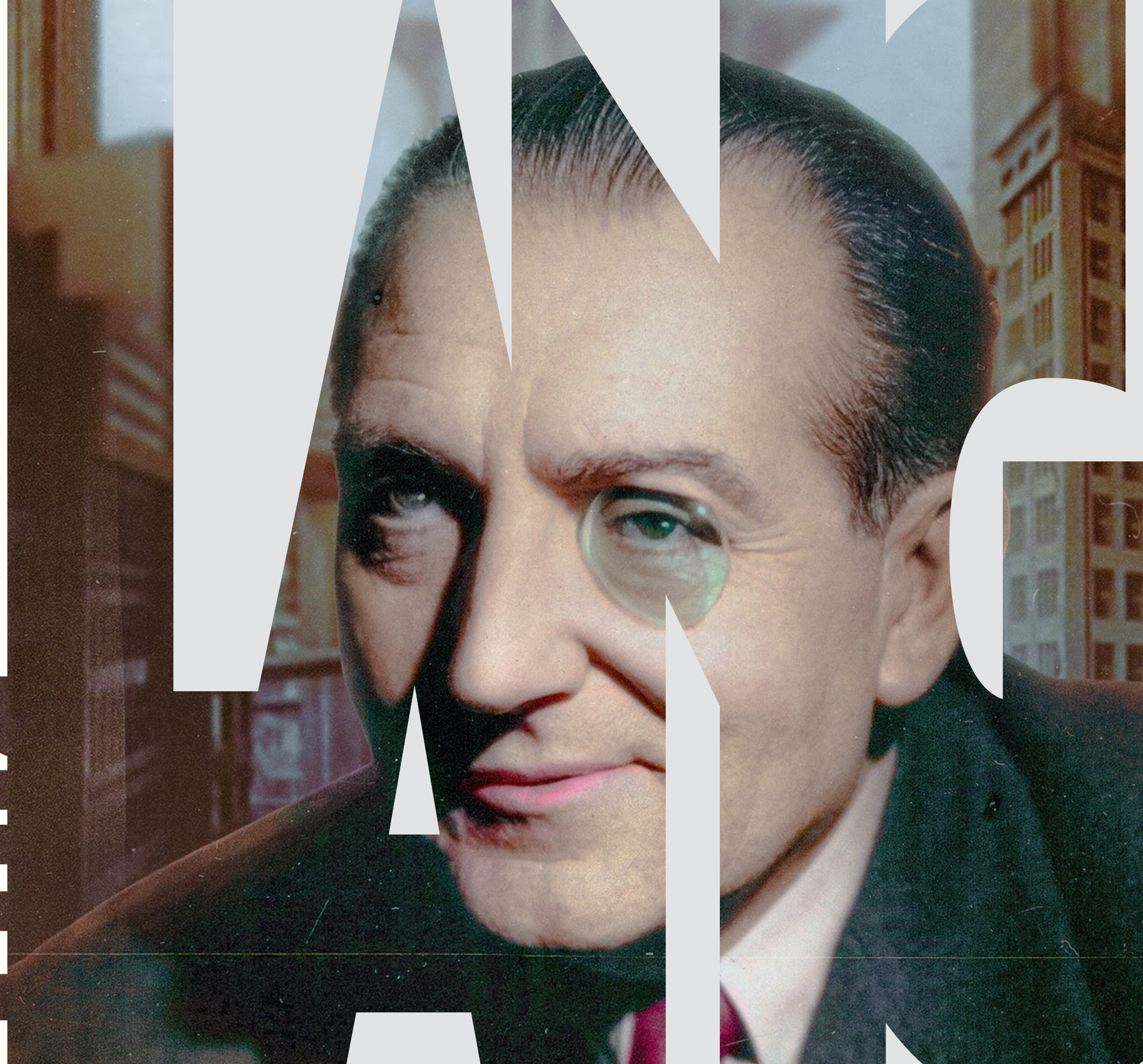


Image by Sunset Boulevard & Colourisation and composition by William Hazevoets

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In conversation with Fritz Lang

Fritz Lang was an Austrian-born German-American film director, screenwriter, and producer who worked in Germany and later the United States. One of the best-known émigrés from Germany's school of Expressionism, he was dubbed the "Master of Darkness" by the British Film Institute (BFI). He has been cited as one of the most influential filmmakers of all time. Lang's most celebrated films include the groundbreaking futuristic science-fiction film *Metropolis* (1927) and the influential *M* (1931), a film noir precursor. His 1929 film *Woman in the Moon* showcased the use of a multi-stage rocket, and also pioneered the concept of a rocket launch pad (a rocket standing upright against a tall building before launch having been slowly rolled into place) and the rocket-launch countdown clock.

Welcome to our studio, and thank you for joining us. You've directed so many influential films throughout your career. Of all the works you've created, is there one that stands out to you as your personal favorite, or one that you hold closest to your heart?

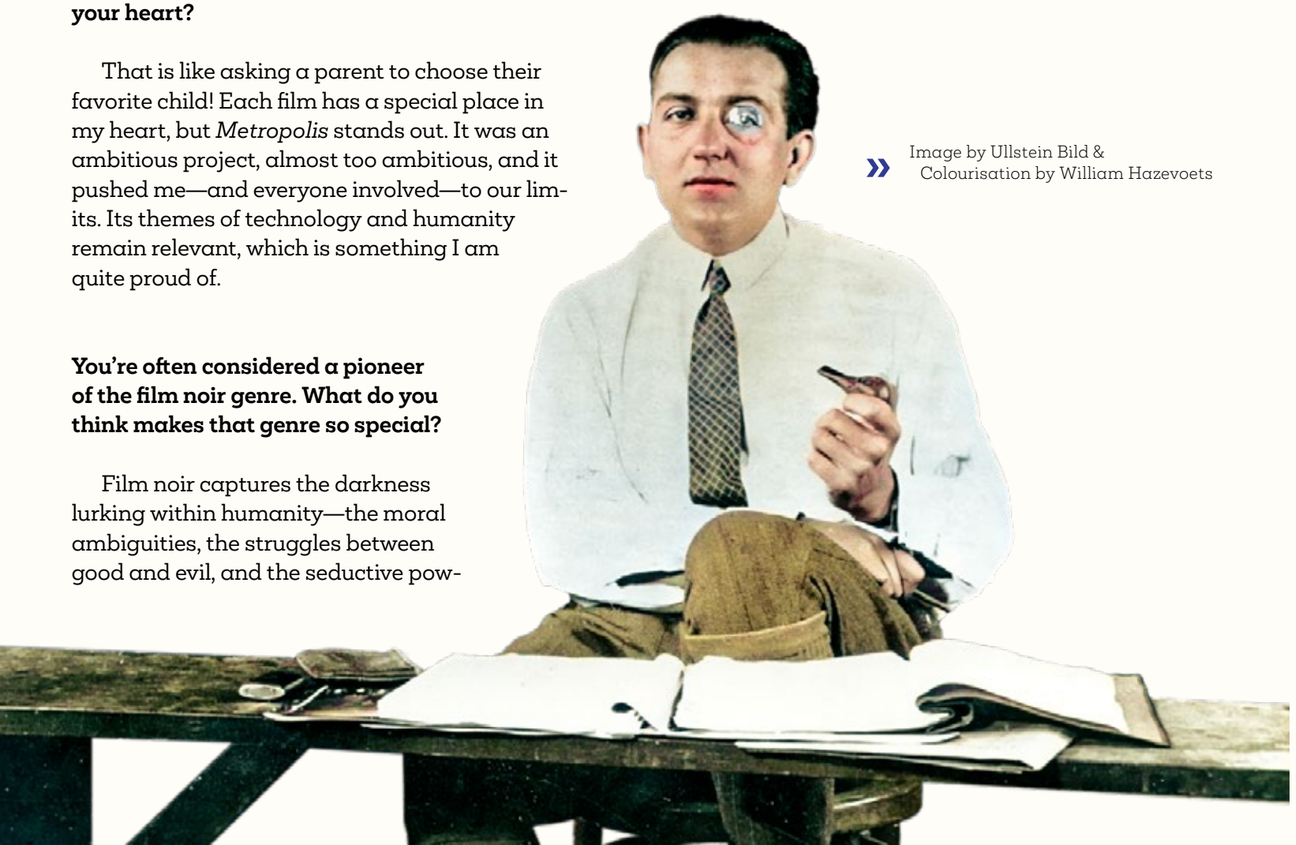
That is like asking a parent to choose their favorite child! Each film has a special place in my heart, but *Metropolis* stands out. It was an ambitious project, almost too ambitious, and it pushed me—and everyone involved—to our limits. Its themes of technology and humanity remain relevant, which is something I am quite proud of.

You're often considered a pioneer of the film noir genre. What do you think makes that genre so special?

Film noir captures the darkness lurking within humanity—the moral ambiguities, the struggles between good and evil, and the seductive power of shadows. Life is not black and white, and noir explores that complexity. I think audiences connect with its honesty; it does not try to sugarcoat reality. It also allowed me to experiment with lighting, framing, and storytelling in ways that were both artistic and deeply personal.

Was the transition from silent films to talkies difficult for you?

At first, yes. Silent films are pure visual storytelling, and I loved that. When sound was introduced, it felt like a disruption—it required a whole new way of thinking about the craft. But I embraced it. Sound opened new possibilities, especially for creating atmosphere and tension. It's like adding another instrument to the orchestra



» Image by Ullstein Bild & Colourisation by William Hazevoets

I'm a fan of *Metropolis's* scrolling intertitles. I love how they represent the city. What inspired this? Did you know how trendsetting it would be? They remind me of Star Wars intros.

Thank you! I believed the intertitles were an integral part of the storytelling. They set the tone and establish a world before the first image even appears on screen. For *Metropolis*, I wanted the intertitles to reflect the grandeur and complexity of the city itself, almost like a character in the film. As for being trendsetting—no, I didn't know! But I'm glad they left an impression. It's wonderful to think they might have inspired others, even decades later.

So tief die Stadt der Arbeiter unter der Erde lag, so hoch über ihr türmte sichder Häuserblock, der "Klub der Söhne" hiess, mit seinen Hörsälen und Bibliotheken, seinen Theatern und Stadions.

» The original german scrolling intertitle from *Metropolis* which is shaped to look like a city

When you made *The Testament of Dr. Mabuse*, did you expect the Nazi party to become as powerful as it eventually did?

I feared as much, yes. The signs were all there, and I tried to channel my concerns into Testament. Mabuse represents a force of chaos and control, which mirrored what I saw happening in Germany. The censorship of the film by the Nazis only confirmed that I had struck a nerve. I wish more people had recognized the warning signs back then.

***Metropolis* was long believed to be incomplete due to censorship and lost footage. Now that the film has been fully restored, what's your reaction to seeing it whole again?**

It's a bittersweet feeling, to be honest. *Metropolis* was always a victim of forces beyond my control—censorship, studio politics, and the cutting of material that was essential to my vision. To see the film restored now, with all the missing pieces finally recovered, is both a triumph and a reminder of how fragile art can be. I'm deeply grateful to the preservationists who have worked tirelessly to bring the film back to its intended form. It's not just a victory for me, but for the art of cinema itself, proving that what is lost can, in some cases, be found again.

Many of your films deal with themes of control, power, and rebellion. Why do you think you were drawn to those ideas?

Perhaps it was my own life that led me there. I lived through the collapse of an empire, revolutions, and the rise of dangerous ideologies. Power and control shape everything—society, art, even personal relationships. I wanted my films to explore how these forces work on people, how they can corrupt, and, ultimately, how they can be resisted. It is through rebellion, through questioning, that we find our humanity.

Thank you so much for your time, Herr Lang. It's been an honor to speak with you.

The pleasure was mine. Thank you for such thoughtful questions.

A new banknote for a new country



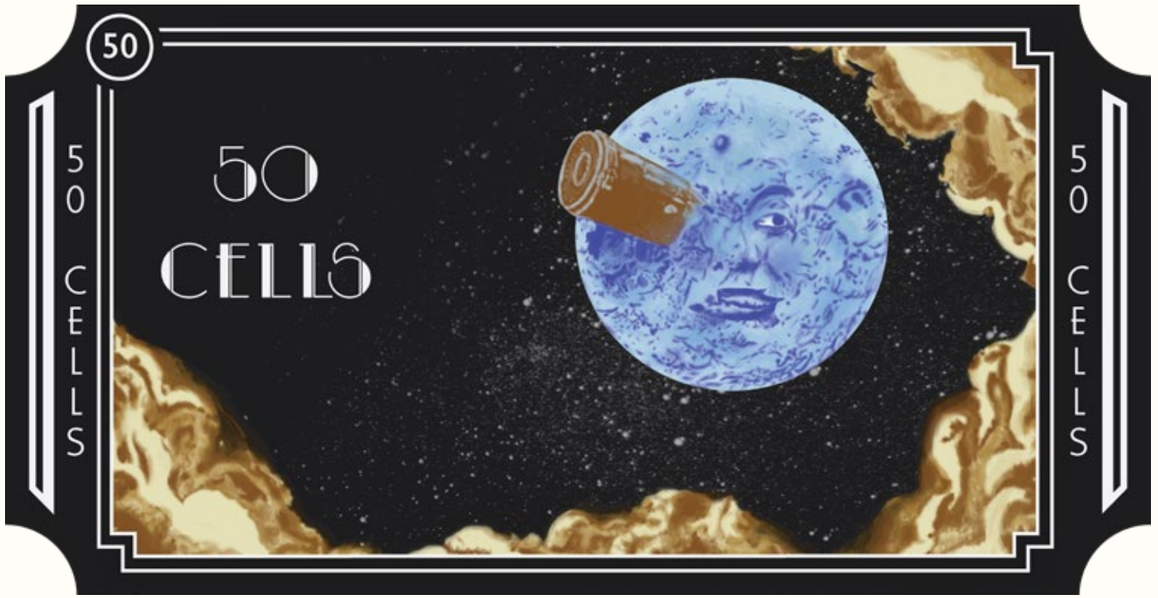
» The back of the 50 Cells banknote

Restoria proudly unveils its brand-new 50 Cells banknote! As a nation rooted in the preservation and celebration of film history, it was only natural for our currency to reflect this passion. Our banknotes are designed to honor iconic films that have profoundly shaped the art and craft of cinema.

For our inaugural design, we've selected scenes from five groundbreaking films: *Le Voyage dans la Lune* (1902), Georges Méliès's pioneering sci-fi adventure; *Seven Samurai* (1954), Akira Kurosawa's epic tale of courage and teamwork; *Star Wars* (1977), the space saga that revolutionized visual effects; *Toy Story* (1995), Pixar's groundbreaking first fully computer-animated film; and *Interstellar* (2014), Christopher Nolan's exploration of space and time.

These films were chosen for their innovation and impact on the medium. The name "Cells" for our currency pays homage to the individual frames—or "cells"—of film that bring stories to life.By linking our currency to these iconic films, we aim to emphasize Restoria's commitment to preserving and celebrating the legacy of storytelling through cinema. Who says money can't be art?

» The front of the 50 Cells banknote



Final Lost Segment of *Metropolis* (1927) Found in Perfect Condition



» **Above:** The workers going to the machines
» **Oposite Page:** The tower of Babel

In an extraordinary discovery that has captivated both film enthusiasts and historians, the final missing segment of Fritz Lang's groundbreaking film *Metropolis* has been found. The fragment, located in a private collection in Zurich, completes the legendary silent film – a milestone in cinematic history. This news is being hailed as one of the most exciting finds in the world of cinema.

The missing segment, a crucial six-minute scene revealing the mysterious origins of the "Machine Man," had been lost since the film's premiere in 1927. For nearly a century, the fate of this fragment remained a mystery that intrigued film scholars and fuelled speculation. The discovery sheds new light on the depth of Lang's vision and offers fans a rare opportunity to better understand the film's intricate themes, which resonate even today.

The footage was uncovered in a sealed film reel that had gone unnoticed for generations in a family archive. In addition to the long-sought scene, the reel contains several alternate shots and fragments of higher quality than the 25 minutes of additional scenes discovered in an Argentine archive in 2008. "The condition of this footage is almost unbelievable," said Dr. Anna Keller, head archivist at the Deutsche Kinemathek. "It looks as though it was developed just yesterday. To find something this intact after almost a century is nothing short of miraculous."

> **"The condition of this footage is almost unbelievable"**

Film historians at the Deutsche Kinemathek have already begun the meticulous process of integrating the footage into the latest restoration of *Metropolis*. This painstaking effort ensures that the restored film matches Lang's original vision. A public screening of the fully restored film is scheduled for late 2025, accompanied by a live performance of the original orchestral score by Gottfried Huppertz. This event is already being hailed as a landmark moment in the history of film preservation and cultural restoration.

Experts believe the rediscovered scene provides deeper insight into the revolutionary social and philosophical themes of the film, including class struggle, technological advancement, and the relationship between the levels in society. These themes, central to *Metropolis*, have inspired countless filmmakers and scholars over the years and remain deeply relevant in the modern age. Some speculate that the additional material could even contain visual clues that subtly expand on the Machine Man's symbolic role, representing both humanity's aspirations and its fears in the face of industrialisation.

Beyond its artistic and historical value, this find has rekindled discussions about the importance of preserving cinematic heritage. With so much of early cinema lost to time – whether due to neglect, deterioration, or deliberate destruction – the rediscovery of this footage serves as a powerful reminder of what could still be hidden. Organisations and archivists around the world are using this as a case study, exploring ways to better protect and recover what remains of our shared cultural history.

The discovery has also reignited excitement among cinephiles and academics alike. Scholars are particularly interested in the psychological motivations of the characters and how the rediscovered scene deepens the interplay between the film's visual storytelling and its underlying themes.

"Finally seeing *Metropolis* as Fritz Lang originally intended is a monumental moment," said Dr. Keller. "This is not only a victory for film preservation but also a reminder of the cultural treasures that may still lie hidden, waiting to be uncovered in private collections and archives around the world?"

The restored version of *Metropolis* is eagerly anticipated worldwide. Screenings featuring live panel discussions with film scholars and restoration experts. This global celebration is expected to cement *Metropolis*'s place as a timeless cultural icon.



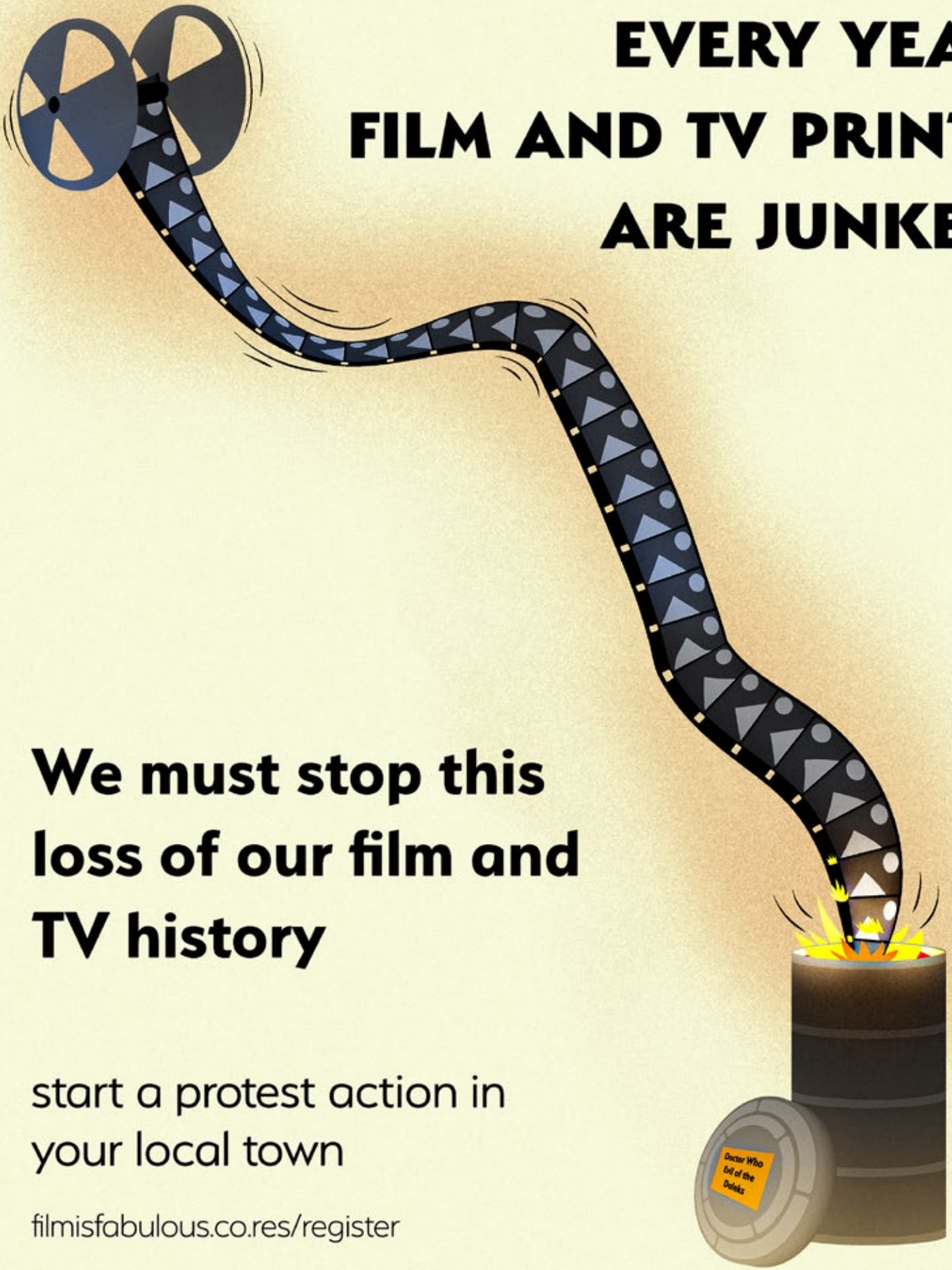
Universal Announces 4K HDR Release of *All Quiet on the Western Front* (1930)

Universal has announced the upcoming release of a restored 4K HDR version of the 1930 classic *All Quiet on the Western Front*. The groundbreaking adaptation of Erich Maria Remarque's novel, has undergone an extensive digital restoration. *All Quiet on the Western Front* is one of the most influential anti-war films of all time," said Sarah Mitchell, head of Universal's Home Entertainment. "With this restoration, we hope to bring its powerful message to resonate with a new generation"

New *Nosferatu* (1922) Remake Directed by Robert Eggers

Robert Eggers (*The Witch, The Northman*) is creating a modern take on the horror classic *Nosferatu*, starring Willem Dafoe and Lily-Rose Depp. The film combines Eggers' attention to historical detail with a visually stunning desaturated style and will be released in cinemas on December 25th. "It's an honor to breathe new life into this timeless story," Eggers said.

EVERY YEAR FILM AND TV PRINTS ARE JUNKED



We must stop this loss of our film and TV history

start a protest action in your local town

filmisfabulous.co.res/register